

Merry Christmas from the McMillans

December 2025

Friends and family,

Another year in the books. Henry wrapped up his nineteenth season leading the Wildcats. The team made the playoffs and the seniors made him proud, which is the part he actually talks about at dinner. Maggie keeps the library and half the school running over at Whittier and somehow still keeps the rest of us fed and on time.

Claire is thriving in Denver and calls every Sunday, usually to tell her father to retire and learn to relax. Patrick is deep into his kinesiology program in Madison and came home for Thanksgiving long enough to beat his dad at cards and raid the freezer. We are grateful for both of them and for the miles that phones make shorter.

The big news this year is small and quiet: the house is paid off. Henry says that is the only trophy that pays you back. We spent a long weekend at the cabin at Salt Fork, fixed the dock, caught a few, and called it a celebration.

We will make the shortbread and the cranachan on Christmas Eve like always, raise a glass to the ones who are not at the table this year, and be thankful for the ones who are. Slainte, and love from our house to yours.

Henry, Maggie, Claire, and Patrick